Back to Basics

An off-grid urban village that operates for and with the people of Hackney Wick. This 35 sqm housing unit offers a low-cost, community-focused alternative to conventional development, built from hempcrete and timber to create a net-zero energy, off-grid home.



The project responds to social and economic data on Hackney Wick, providing affordable live-work units for residents facing displacement. Passive design, hempcrete construction and on-site energy storage combine into a replicable, net-zero off-grid housing model.

01/01/2023 - date started

15/03/2023 - date ended

Documents by Sebastian Dawber
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Created for ...
eg BSc Architecuture and enviromental design
Undergraduate RIBA ARB part I

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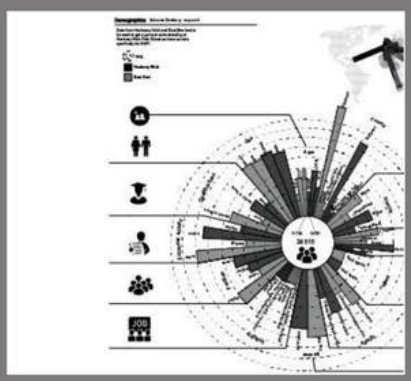
SEBASTIAN VICTOR DAWBER
Independent Project
BSc Part 1, ARB RIBA , Architecture and environmental design

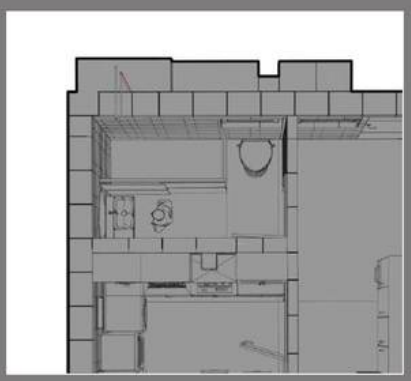
Back to Basics

Off-Grid Housing for Hackney Wick

15/03/2023 - date ended

This document presents Back to Basics, an off-grid urban housing scheme for Hackney Wick, London. Back to times of the past, it proposes an off-grid urban village that operates for and with the local community, providing a 35 sqm living unit as a solution to displacement and housing affordability. New developments in the area often displace existing residents; this project offers a low-cost alternative that lets the community remain and thrive off-grid. Storage energy for weathering days and passive environmental strategies combine with hempcrete and timber to create a green, net-zero energy build. The scheme sits within a larger community district including a cafe, crop-growing, workspaces, learning rooms, exhibition spaces and social housing, aimed at increasing cohesion and self-sufficiency. A place of living for today, tomorrow, and many days thereafter - a solution for the new world problem.







Back to Basics

Sebastian Victor Dawber

Back to times of the past. An off-grid urban village that operates for and with the people of Hackney wick. This housing unit serving a 35sqm living space is a solution to many problems.

New developments are leading to the disappearance of those who created it, the local community who are now seeking new jobs and homes, leading to a division between old and new comers. The proposed living unit provides an alternative to low cost housing which serves as a way to live with a reduction to ones cost of living. Systems built for and around the unit create the ability to live completely off the grid from public services. Storage energy for weathering days and environmental strategies proposed to create passive-house design outcomes. Environmental analysis work was completed to allow for a practical understanding to the matter with the passive design creating many positive outcomes. The use of environmentally friendly materials serves as the key solution, hempcrete used with additives and timber provides a green build design to create the practicality of this proposed passive net zero energy off gird housing unit

The location is placed on a larger design idea based off thesis work. The idea is to create community district that works with than rather fighting with new and old residents, a place for commerce for all. An urban community that has public and private access, welcoming all to the site. To grow the community, spaces such as: a café, crop growing, workspaces, learning rooms, exhibition spaces and social housing—aimed to increase cohesion amongst the community. Further explored in a chance to work on-site to partake in a hempcrete self-build project. People can live on-site and grow their own spaces. The site services use traditional and modern strategies to create an off grid industrial processing space.

A place of living for today, tomorrow and many days thereafter . A solution for the new world problem

1. Location- Function
2. Site- Form
3. Plan. Section , Elevation
4. Detailed Section and Plan
5. Rendered Views

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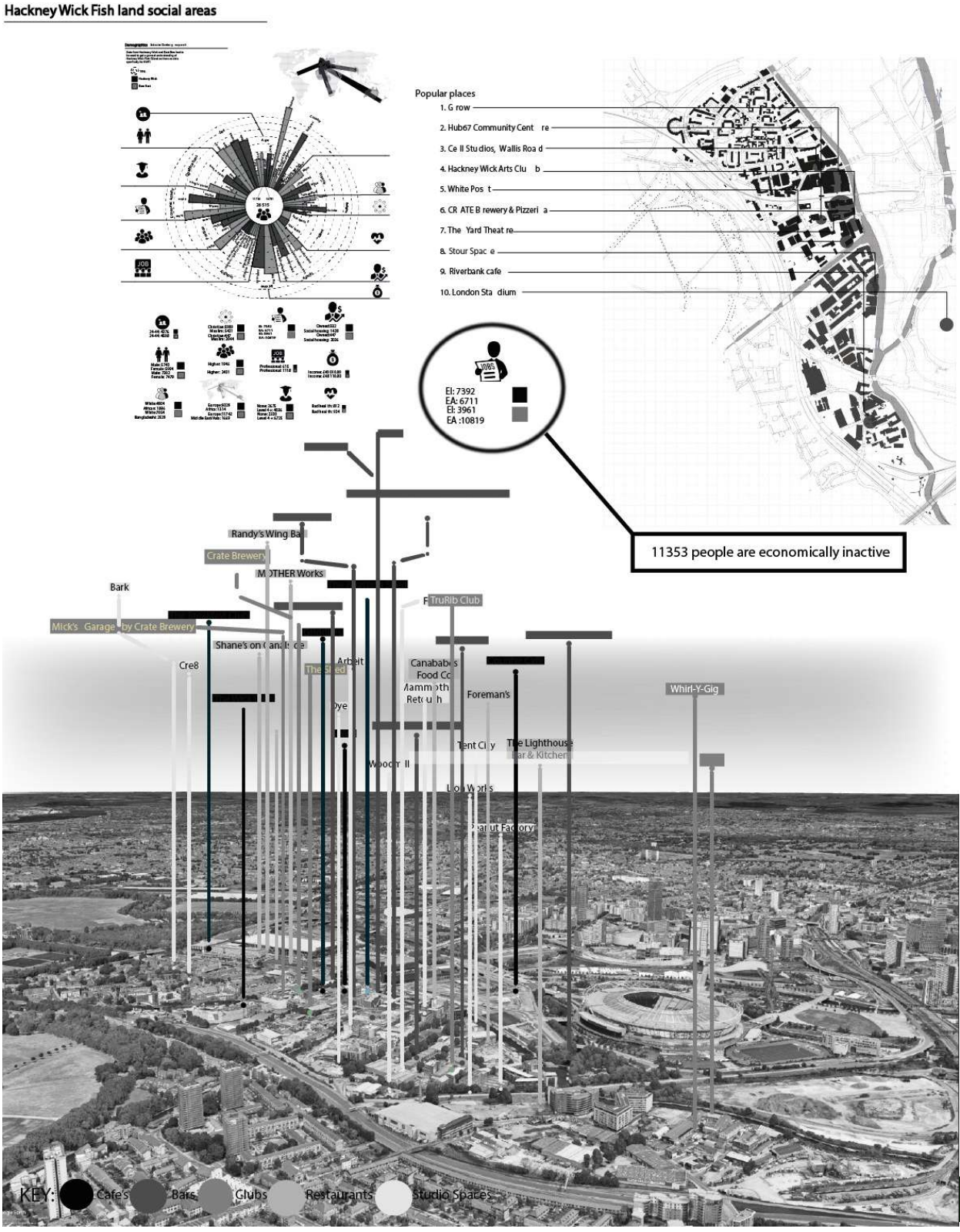
Link to thesis work:

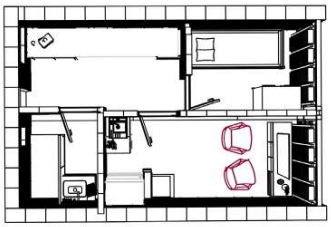
The concept creates a off-grid home for people in the area who are not economically active, this will reduce their living expenses dramatically. Using online data a social analysis was completed to derive the data to create the focus for the users.

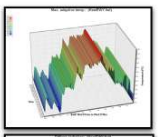
The location is in the centre of Hackney Wick London United Kingdom. Close to nearby social locations one does not need to travel far in order to get around.

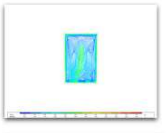
The 37 sqm space is part of a much larger project with this housing unit being a key part in concept. A space for people to live, work and grow their needed material for the housing project.

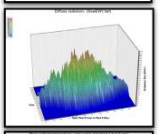
The unit is multiplied several times in order to give living spaces for varied users but the housing unit its self is singular in design and implementation.

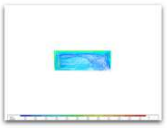


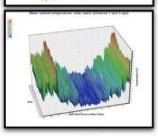


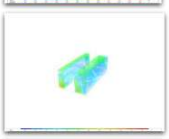


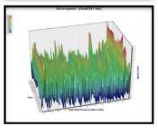




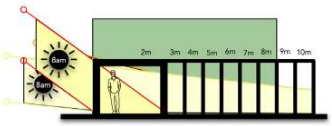


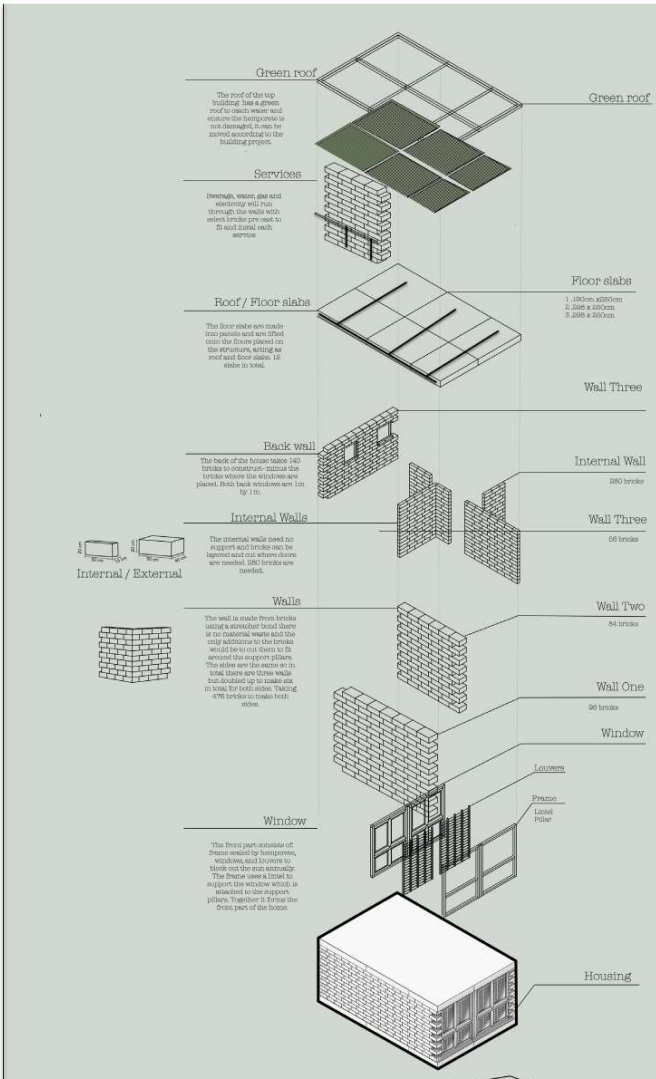


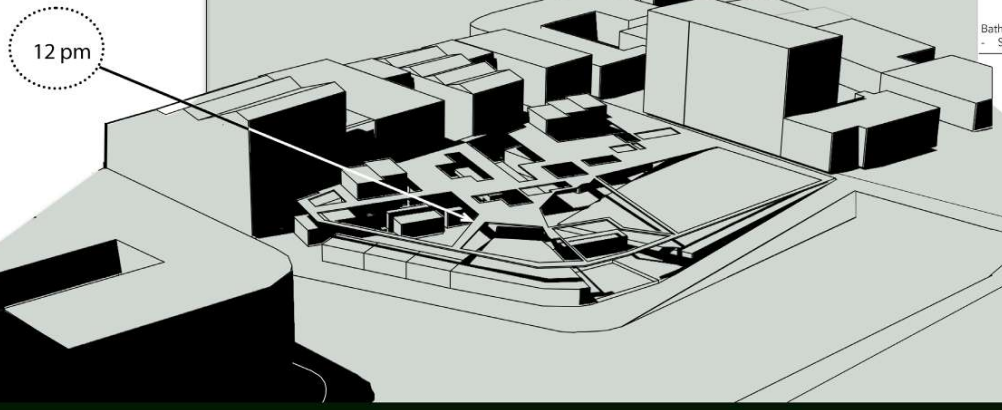








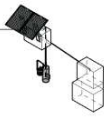




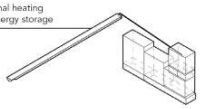
Composting toilet
- Food for plants



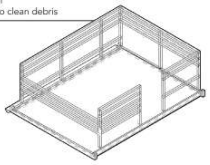
Water collection
- Purification system



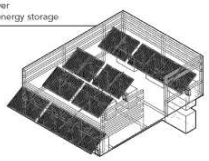
Solar thermal heating
- With energy storage



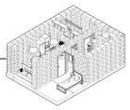
Green roof
- Moss to clean debris



Solar Power
- With energy storage



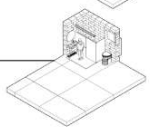
Bedroom
- 1 - 2 people



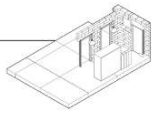
Living area
- Kitchen and living essentials

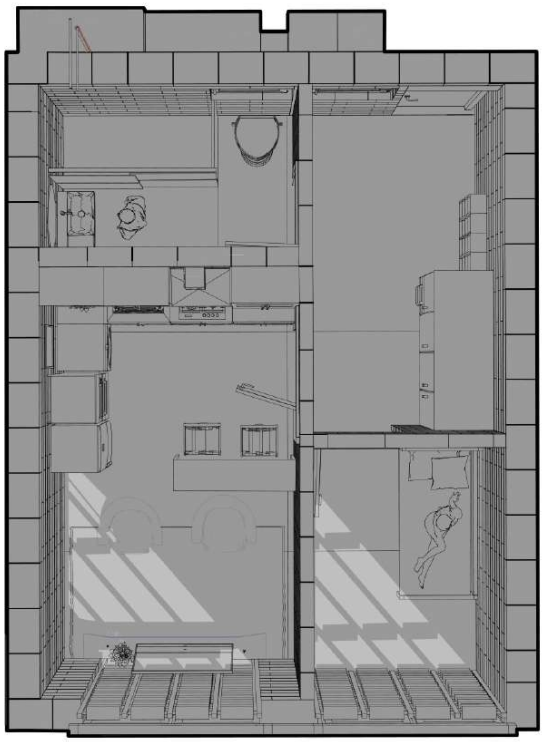


Hallway
- Storage



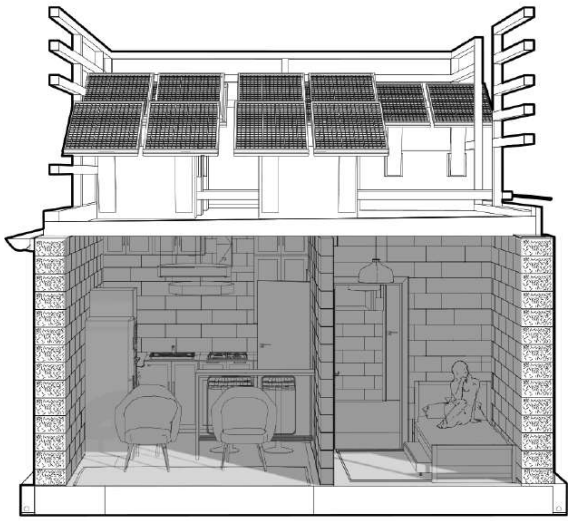
Bathroom
- Shower and toilet





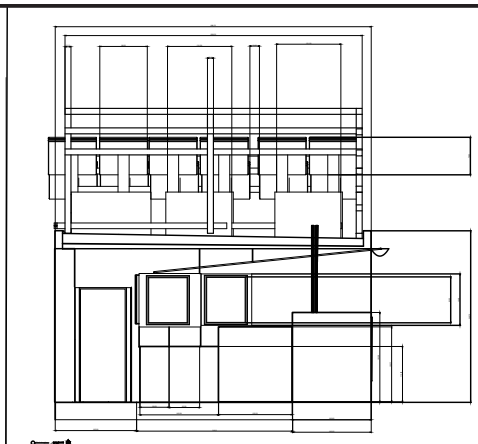


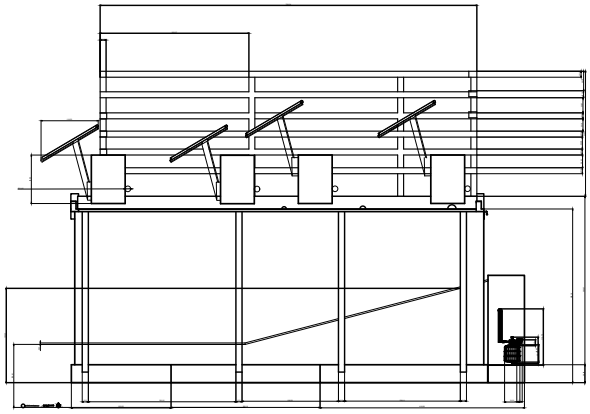
Early wake up then shower with LED lighting to help wake up, the sun kissed eyes from the low lighting helps the brain wake-up naturally

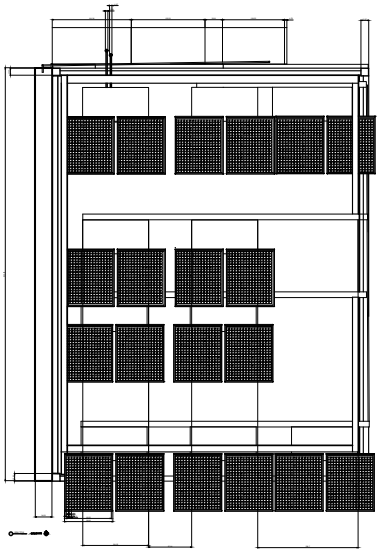


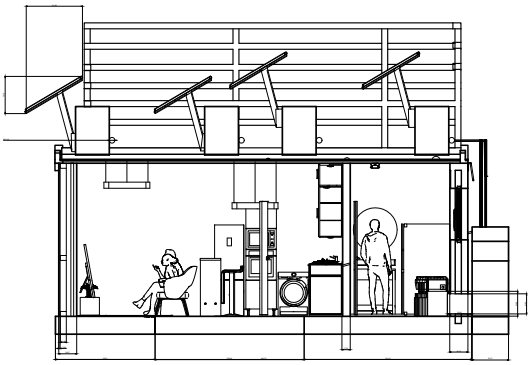


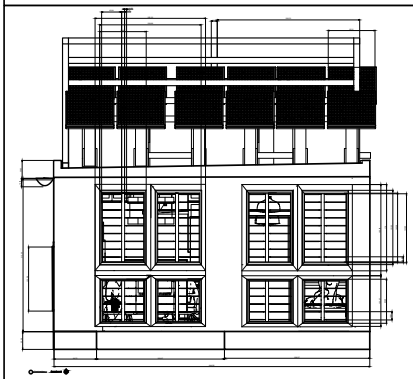
A perfectly curated bedroom to fit a single bed as well as a pull-out for two people. The south facing room with shutters allows for a natural way to start your day

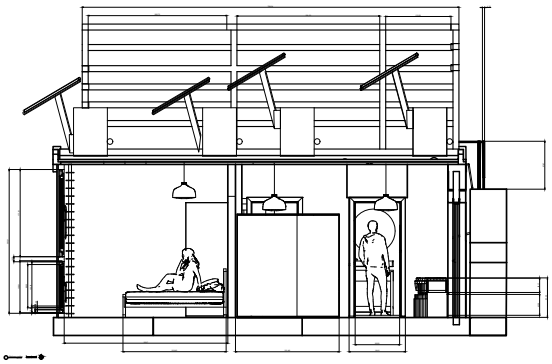












REVISIONS

REVISIONS

DRAWING

Plan / Sections / Elevations

PROJECT TITLE

Back to basics

PRINCIPAL

Sebastian Victor Dawber
Forbidden roots . Ltd.

PROJECT ADDRESS

London 1
Hackney Wick

CAD REF	DATE
00000001	April 2020

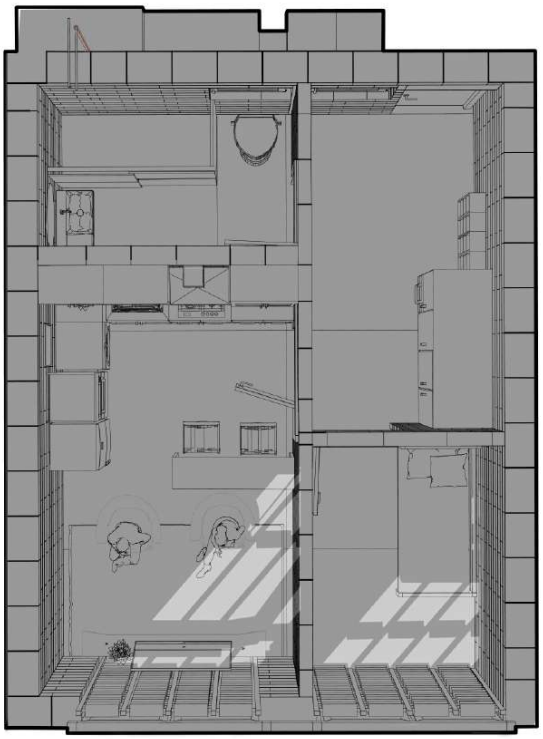
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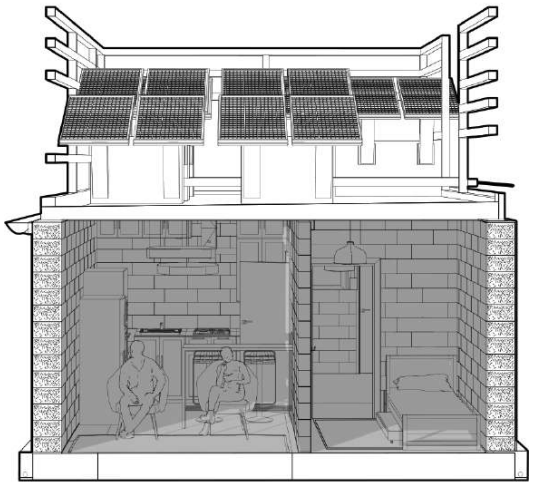
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The open plan kicthen and living area offers further envirmental control as well as creating a seperate space for living.





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Documents by Sebastian Dawber

Dissertation
Research into ..



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BSc Architecture and environmental design
Undergraduate RIBA ARB part I

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2023

This document summarises Back to Basics, an off-grid housing competition entry for Hackney Wick. The scheme demonstrates how hempcrete construction, passive design and on-site energy systems can deliver affordable, net-zero live-work units, and can be used as a reference for future off-grid or community-led housing projects.



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